SALOME YICHI ZHANG

Composer · Sound Artist · Music Technologist
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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Salome Yichi Zhang (b. 2002) is an award-winning Chinese-Canadian composer and sound artist working across sound art, film, and music technology. In New York City, her multichannel and multimedia works have been presented at THE BLANC, Flohaus Gallery, and NYU′s Audio Lab, including work produced by Michael Schumacher. While studying in Boston, her work was presented at Cyber Arts Gallery, Emerson Media Art Studio, and Fenway Art Studio.

Zhang began her composition studies at the University of Toronto on a top-level scholarship before transferring to Berklee College of Music as a recipient of its World Tour Scholarship Award. She earned a B.M. in Electronic Production and Design and Film Scoring and was mentored by Neil Leonard at the Berklee Interdisciplinary Arts Institute. After graduation, she continued working with Leonard as a production assistant on Midtown Sound: Listening Legacy, his solo exhibition at THE BLANC.

She has contributed music and sound to independent features, television productions, and more than 20 short films and animations. She was one of the sound designers on *Blue Planet Outside the Window*, the first live-action 8K documentary filmed entirely in space, and contributed to *Hope You Have a Good Trip*, the final feature by internationally acclaimed Tibetan filmmaker Pema Tseden, alongside projects with iQIYI and MIT′s Project Prakash. In 2025, her string quartet composition was featured on the Gaia Quartet′s Canadian tour and presented at the Canadian Music Centre in Toronto.

ARTISTIC & RESEARCH STATEMENT

My practice explores womanhood, migration, memory, and cultural inheritance through composition, sound, color, and technology. Drawing from film composition, I work through a ′show, don′t tell′ approach, using metaphor, symbolism, spatial sound, physical processes, and recurring motifs such as blue to suggest emotional and lived experience indirectly. My growing interest in music cognition and neuroscience comes from asking why particular musical choices communicate particular emotions, and from observing how directors and collaborators often describe musical intent through emotional, contextual, and metaphorical language.

EDUCATION

Berklee College of Music — Boston, USA · 2023–2026
Bachelor of Music in Electronic Production and Design & Film Scoring

- Minor in Creative Coding
- Specialization in Sound Design for Video Games
- Affiliation: Berklee Interdisciplinary Arts Institute
- Berklee College of Music World Tour Scholarship

University of Toronto — Toronto, Canada · 2020–2023
Bachelor of Music in Composition

- Focused on orchestration, chamber writing, and interdisciplinary collaboration
- University of Toronto Entrance Scholarship

BERKLEE INTERDISCIPLINARY ARTS INSTITUTE

Berklee Interdisciplinary Arts Institute (BIAI) — Boston, USA · 2025–2026
Interdisciplinary Artist / Production Assistant

- Mentored by Neil Leonard through the Berklee Interdisciplinary Arts Institute
- Developed interdisciplinary projects including Connecting Lines, CLOUD, and In-Between, integrating composition, spatial audio, interactive systems, video, installation, and creative technology
- Production Assistant — Confluence: A Berklee Interdisciplinary Arts Institute Showcase, THE BLANC, New York
  - Curated and artistically directed by Neil Leonard; first collaboration between THE BLANC and BIAI
- Production Assistant — Neil Leonard, Midtown Sound: Listening Legacy, THE BLANC, New York, 2026
  - Leonard′s inaugural New York solo exhibition and THE BLANC′s inaugural artist-in-residence exhibition

SELECTED AWARDS, COMPETITIONS & JURIED SELECTIONS

- **Vivaldi International Competition** — Absolute First Prize for Original Composition / Film & Game Music
- **International Computer Music Conference Berklee Call for Student Multichannel Work** — Finalist

- **Denny Awards International Electronic Music Competition** — Best Film Score, Cheat-code
- **LevelUp Showcase, presented by Ubisoft** — Honorable Mention, Best Game 2023, Red Herring
- **SMTH International Contest, 5th Edition** — Winner, Poetic Architecture, In-Between (Excerpt), 2026
- **Cannes Indie Shorts Award** — Semifinalist, In-Between, Cannes, France, 2026
- **IMMERSED 2.0, Bedford Trio** — Selected Composer, Call for Works, Blue
- **Gaia Quartet** — Selected Composer, Call for Works, Dawn; featured on the ensemble′s 2025 Canadian tour and presented at the Canadian Music Centre
- **University of Toronto Entrance Scholarship**
- **Berklee College of Music World Tour Scholarship**

SELECTED WORKS & INSTALLATIONS

The Blue Left Spinning — Kinetic Sound Sculpture / Solo Exhibition New York, NY · 2026

Main Artist: Salome Yichi Zhang · Guest Multimedia Visual Artist: Anna Ren · Curator: Neil Leonard · Thesis Director: Ryan Page

- Featured work: Porcelain Sequencer Audio-visual Projection
- Flohaus exhibition page · ArtRabbit · Artsy · Artforum Artguide
- Monday Music documentation — "Documenting The Blue Left Spinning: A Kinetic Sound Sculpture by Salome Yichi Zhang"

In-Between — Audiovisual / Experimental Media Work New York, NY · Dec 2025–Present

- Digerati Experimental Media Festival — Replay — Official Selection
- Cubicten — The Ultimate Prototype Digital Forest — Exhibitor, New York, NY
- Cannes Indie Shorts Award — Semifinalist, Cannes, France, 2026
- SMTH International Contest, 5th Edition — Poetic Architecture — Winner, In-Between (Excerpt), Various Cities, Spain, 2026
  - Displayed at 13 venues across Madrid, Alicante, Vitoria, Seville, Bilbao, Murcia, and Barcelona
- AURORA Video Art Night (VAN 2026) — AT&T Discovery District — Exhibitor, In-Between (Excerpt), Dallas, TX

CONCERT WORKS

Dawn — for String Quartet Toronto, Canada · Dec 2024

- Written in 2024 and dedicated to Gaia Quartet
- Premiered in October 2025
- Featured on Gaia Quartet′s 2025 Canadian tour and presented at the Canadian Music Centre in Toronto
- Canadian Music Centre — Gaia Quartet, CMC Artists in Residence: In Time Album Launch Event

Blue — for Piano Trio Toronto, Canada · Apr 2023

- Dedicated to Bedford Trio
- Premiered at the IMMERSED 2.0 concert

FILM, TELEVISION & INTERACTIVE MEDIA

Independent Screen Composer / Sound Designer Canada & USA · May 2022–Present

- Composer and sound director for *In the Blue*, a Los Angeles-based independent feature film (in production)
- Composer for indie feature film *Once Upon a Time in* Boston, planned theatre distribution 2027-2028
- Contributed music and sound to more than 20 short films and animations associated with AFI, USC, RISD, Chapman, Emerson, University of Toronto, School of the Art Institute of Chicago, SCAD, Sheridan
- Worked across composition, sound design, foley, preparing cue sheets, spotting notes, score preparation, and Pro Tools recording and mixing
- Projects selected by or associated with Festival de Cannes, Pingyao International Film Festival, Toronto International Nollywood Film Festival, LA Shorts International Film Festival, Cannes Indie Shorts, FIRST International Film Festival, Green Point Film Festival, Asia International Youth Film Festival, Shanghai International Film Festival, and HiShorts! Xiamen Short Film Week

Shi Music Studio — Additional Music Composer Beijing, China · 2025–Present

- Worked under music director Shimu Chen
- Composed commercial tracks for actor Yuxi Ding and Snack Paper
- Composed for Tibetan director Pema Tseden′s final feature film *Hope You Have a Good Trip*
- Composed music and created synthesizer sound designs for the iQIYI television series *Deep in the Wumeng Mountains*《乌蒙深处》

1HR22MIN — Dir. Andy Liu — Composer & Audio Director Los Angeles, CA · Apr 2024–Dec 2024

- Collaborated with Zhang Yimou′s post-production team and Los Angeles-based film studio 24K Onions

- Composed 11 minutes of original score
- Delivered 5.1 surround mixes for immersive soundscapes
- Used Frame.io to support post-production workflow

China Central Television (CCTV) — Foley Artist / Sound Post-Production Jul 2025–Aug 2025

- Completed sound post-production for *Blue Planet Outside the Window* 《窗外是蓝星》
- Responsible for foley, sound effects, recording synchronization, editing, sound design, and mixing

LAB PROJECTS

Csound Plugin — Granular Sampler

- Csound/Cabbage sampler prototype with sample playback, envelope controls, and delay

Csound Plugin 02 — FM Synthesis

- FM synthesis instrument with separate carrier and modulation envelopes, presets, and output metering

Machine Learning for Musicians — Music Genre Classifier

- Music genre classification with a convolutional neural network: mel-spectrograms turn audio into visual features for learning across ten genres, with notebooks for preprocessing, training, and prediction, and an analysis of where the model confuses genres

SELECTED PRESS, FEATURES & DOCUMENTATION

- Berklee Electronic Production and Design Newsletter — “EPD Graduate in the News” — Featured The Blue Left Spinning and the Art Mag article “When Broken Porcelain Speaks: Salome Yichi Zhang′s The Blue Left Spinning,” 2026
- Berklee Electronic Production and Design Instagram — What Are You Making? — Featured artist spotlight on The Blue Left Spinning, 2026
- Art Mag — “Salome Yichi Zhang: Blue Left Spinning” — Feature on Zhang′s New York exhibition and interdisciplinary installation practice
- Bedford Trio — IMMERSED 2.0 Composer Feature — Artist biography and project feature for Blue

TECHNICAL SKILLS

DAWs: Logic Pro · Pro Tools · Ableton Live · Cubase
Game Audio / Engines: Wwise · Unity · Unreal Engine
Programming / Creative Technology: Max/MSP · Csound · Python · C# · JavaScript · HTML · Arduino · TouchDesigner
Notation: Sibelius · Dorico · MuseScore
Additional Tools: CueDB · ReelCrafter · Final Cut Pro
Specialties: Spatial Audio · Generative Systems · Sound Installation · VR Integration · Interactive Audio · Film Scoring · Sound Design

PERFORMANCE & OTHER CREATIVE EXPERIENCE

- **Piano** — Ophelia Ariadne, Metamorphosis — Performed the New York premiere of Ariadne′s graphic score at THE BLANC, New York, NY
- **Live Electronics & Keyboard** — Yuval Gar, RIFT — Performed at the WaterFire Arts Center, Providence, RI
- **Bass Guitarist** — Performed with an indie rock band at El Mocambo, Queen Elizabeth Theatre, and Victoria College, with audiences of 4,000+
- **Music Influencer / Creative-Platform Presence** — 15,000+ engagements